

THRESHOLD ENTERPRISE SYSTEMS

Business Continuity Policy

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1. CONFIDENTIAL CLASSIFICATION AND STRATEGIC OBJECTIVE

*** CONFIDENTIAL POLICY - RESTRICTED TO OPERATIONS MANAGEMENT, SECURITY LEADERSHIP, AND EXECUTIVE INCIDENT TEAMS ***

This document establishes the proprietary enterprise business continuity management framework, disaster recovery objectives, Business Impact Analysis (BIA) methodologies, crisis command structures, and multi-region failover protocols for Threshold Enterprise Systems. It is classified as CONFIDENTIAL. Access is restricted strictly to authorized operational leaders and senior technical managers (MANAGER, OPERATIONS_MANAGER, SECURITY_ENGINEER, ADMIN). General employees and non-administrative technical roles are not authorized to retrieve this document within the knowledge base.

The strategic objective of this Business Continuity Policy is to ensure that Threshold Enterprise Systems can withstand, rapidly respond to, and successfully recover from catastrophic operational disruptions—including major regional cloud datacenter outages, physical infrastructure devastation, global telecommunications severances, cyber disasters, or key supplier insolvencies—while preserving client data integrity, maintaining statutory compliance, and restoring mission-critical customer operations within strict Recovery Time Objectives (RTO) and Recovery Point Objectives (RPO).

In accordance with corporate governance mandates, this policy strictly omits live disaster recovery IP ranges, cryptographic master keys, server addresses, or physical security facility schematics, focusing comprehensively on crisis governance, impact criteria, and failover frameworks.

2. Clear Tri-Partite Scope Distinction: Business Continuity vs. Incidents

To ensure organizational precision and prevent operational role confusion, Threshold Enterprise Systems enforces strict boundaries separating Business Continuity from localized operational incident categories:

- Business Continuity (OPS-004):** Focuses on macro-level organizational survival, disaster recovery, regional infrastructure failover, crisis communications, and sustained business operations during catastrophic, multi-service disruptions. Owned by the Business Continuity Steering Committee and Global Operations Management.
- Engineering Incident Management (ENG-006):** Focuses on localized microservice outages, application code defects, database connection exhaustion, or broken deployments managed by on-call engineers and SREs.
- Cybersecurity Incident Response (SEC-004):** Focuses on defending against and investigating intentional adversarial cyberattacks, malware incursions, credential theft, or unauthorized data exfiltration managed by the SOC.

4. Artificial Intelligence Incident Management (AIG-009): Focuses on model-specific autonomous failures, hallucinations, toxic output generation, or prompt injection poisoning managed by AI Engineering.
5. Operational Incident Escalation (OPS-006): Focuses on day-to-day service degradation triage, cross-functional dispatch, and operational ticket escalation across squads.

3. Business Impact Analysis (BIA) and Critical Business Services

The Business Continuity Steering Committee conducts annual Business Impact Analyses (BIA) across all global business units to identify critical dependencies and classify enterprise services into four Recovery Priority Tiers:

- Priority Tier 0 - Vital Enterprise Foundation: Identity federation (SSO/OAuth2), cryptographic key management (KMS), DNS authoritative resolution, and core multi-tenant customer database clusters. Recovery Time Objective (RTO): ≤ 1 hour. Recovery Point Objective (RPO): ≤ 5 minutes. Maximum Tolerable Downtime (MTD): 2 hours.
- Priority Tier 1 - Mission-Critical Commercial Services: Customer-facing RAG inference APIs, AI governance policy evaluation engines, and commercial customer web applications. RTO: ≤ 4 hours. RPO: ≤ 15 minutes. MTD: 8 hours.
- Priority Tier 2 - Business-Essential Services: Customer billing portals, internal analytics pipelines, enterprise HRIS systems, and corporate email/collaboration systems. RTO: ≤ 12 hours. RPO: ≤ 1 hour. MTD: 24 hours.
- Priority Tier 3 - Non-Critical Support Functions: Internal developer staging sandboxes, historical knowledge archives, and non-essential reporting tools. RTO: ≤ 48 hours. RPO: ≤ 24 hours. MTD: 72 hours.

Each tier defines explicit resource allocations, redundant cloud standby capacities, and executive notification priority during disasters.

4. Enterprise Disaster Recovery Strategies and Cloud Redundancy

Threshold enforces high-availability multi-region cloud resilience architectures across our primary operating hubs in India (Bangalore/Hyderabad), the United States (North America), the United Kingdom (Europe), and Singapore (Asia-Pacific):

- Active-Passive Regional Warm Standby: Mission-critical Tier 0 and Tier 1 services operate on primary active cloud regions with asynchronous, continuous data replication to geographically separated secondary warm standby regions (> 500 miles apart).
- Automated Health Probes and Traffic Failover: Global latency-based DNS routing with automated health checks continually monitors regional ingress gateways. If a primary cloud region suffers catastrophic loss of connectivity or compute infrastructure, global routing automatically diverts traffic to the secondary warm standby region.
- Database Snapshot and Vector Index Synchronization: Relational database transaction logs (WAL) stream continuously to secondary storage enclaves (ENG-005), and vector indexes (AIG-006) maintain hourly immutable cross-region snapshots to guarantee point-in-time recovery.
- Immutable Air-Gapped Backups: Daily encrypted system backups are replicated to air-gapped, write-once-read-many (WORM) cloud storage enclaves to protect against catastrophic ransomware or administrative account compromise.

5. The Crisis Management Team (CMT) Command Structure

Upon declaration of a formal Business Continuity Disaster, the Crisis Management Team (CMT) immediately assumes centralized command:

- Incident Commander (VP of Global Operations): Exercises executive decision-making authority over failover execution, resource requisition, and business continuity activations.
- Technical Recovery Director (Chief Technology Officer / VP of Engineering): Directs engineering squads executing infrastructure reconstitution, database restore runbooks, and microservice validation.
- Information Security Lead (Chief Information Security Officer): Assesses threat conditions, validates secure cryptographic key restoration, and guarantees compliance with data privacy regulations.

- Communications Officer (VP of Corporate Communications): Owns all authorized external communications with customers, regulatory bodies, media, and executive stakeholders.
- Legal & Regulatory Counsel (General Counsel): Assesses statutory breach notification obligations, contractual SLA liabilities, and international regulatory reporting requirements.
- Alternate Role Succession: Every CMT role must designate two qualified alternates with full operational authority in the event that the primary lead is unreachable.

6. Disaster Declaration Criteria and Activation Workflow

A formal Business Continuity Disaster may only be declared when one or more of the following activation triggers are certified by the Incident Commander:

1. Complete loss or catastrophic unavailability of a primary regional cloud datacenter lasting more than thirty (30) minutes with no immediate resolution.
2. Widespread, irreversible data corruption across primary database clusters affecting multiple multi-tenant customers.
3. Prolonged power, environmental, or physical security destruction compromising a primary engineering development or operations facility.
4. Catastrophic cyber attack (e.g., destructive malware, widespread infrastructure encryption) that completely disables production operations.

Activation Workflow: CMT War Room Convened -> Disaster Declared -> Regional Failover Initiated -> Secondary Systems Verified -> Internal & External Communications Published -> Continuous Recovery Telemetry Tracked.

7. Emergency Communication Protocols and Customer Notifications

Clear, transparent communication is vital during enterprise crises to maintain customer trust and regulatory compliance:

- Out-of-Band Communication Fabric: The CMT maintains isolated, out-of-band communication systems (e.g., dedicated off-network mobile calling bridges, alternative encrypted messaging channels) independent of primary enterprise infrastructure.
- Customer Advisory Thresholds: For Priority Tier 0 and Tier 1 disruptions, formal customer advisories must be transmitted to designated enterprise customer contacts within sixty (60) minutes of disaster declaration.
- Regulatory Notification: If disaster events involve cross-border data availability loss or personal data risk, Legal Counsel executes formal statutory notifications to data protection authorities within mandatory statutory timelines.
- Employee Safety and Accountability: In physical disasters, HR activates the automated emergency employee roll-call system to verify the safety of all workforce members in the affected region.

8. Annual Disaster Recovery Exercises, Drills, and Testing

A business continuity plan is only as reliable as its most recent successful exercise. Threshold enforces mandatory testing schedules:

- Semi-Annual Tabletop Disaster Simulations: The CMT and senior engineering leaders participate in structured tabletop exercises simulating complex regional failure scenarios and evaluating decision-making velocity.
- Annual Production Regional Failover Drill: SRE and Operations teams execute an unannounced, planned regional traffic failover drill, shifting 100% of live traffic to the secondary standby region to validate RTO and RPO benchmarks under real production loads.
- Third-Party Resilience Audits: Independent SOC 2 Type II and ISO 22301 auditors inspect disaster recovery logs, backup restorations, and failover drill reports annually.

- Remediation of Drill Deficiencies: Any recovery step that fails to meet targeted RTO/RPO during a drill must be investigated, patched, and re-tested within sixty (60) calendar days.

9. Cross-Document Governance Interconnections

This policy operates in direct harmony with foundational enterprise operational standards:

- OPS-001: Service Management Policy (Defines service ownership and baseline operational responsibilities).
- OPS-006: Operational Incident Escalation Procedure (Defines operational escalation leading to disaster declaration).
- ENG-004: Production Deployment Guide (Supplies rollback and deployment mechanisms).
- ENG-006: Engineering Incident Management Runbook (Delineates technical engineering incident handling).
- SEC-004: Security Incident Response Policy (Coordinates response to destructive cyber events).
- AIG-009: AI Incident Management Policy (Coordinates handling of catastrophic AI model failures).